



STAGE PLAYS FOR SCHOOLS

ALLEN GILLON



THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

**Humorous and emotional play
highlighting the difficulties associated
with intolerance, disabilities, one punch
cowardly hits and bullying.**

Grades 3 - 12

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

Author: Allen Ray Gillon

COPYRIGHT: THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS – All rights reserved.

Except under the conditions described in the Copyright Act 1968 of Australia and subsequent amendments, no part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form by any means, electronic or otherwise without the prior permission of the Author.

REPRODUCTION: The script of THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS is approved for copying in quantities sufficient for single, non-commercial performance, eg. School Drama Departments.

COMMERCIAL PERFORMANCE: Permission may be obtained for commercial performance of THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS by contacting the Publishers. A nominated commission may be negotiated. Teachers and Directors should take into account Copyright conditions on character names. If there is a possibility of litigation, character names and script may be altered to comply.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR: Born in Bowraville NSW, Allen Gillon qualified as a Teacher for the NSW Department Of Education in 1964, spending almost 25 years as a Primary Teacher. During that time Mr Gillon completed additional courses in musical arrangement at Sydney Conservatorium Of Music. He has written and had published a number of classroom texts, currently in use in Australian Schools. His musical training and experience resulted in his being granted many play and drama assignments, including a huge production of "Oliver" in the Penrith Department Region in 1977, co-ordinating 3 Primary schools, a 250 piece choir and a 13 member orchestra. Mr Gillon's love of writing and school performances led him to write and produce many plays. Public acceptance and the success of these plays led to the production of this publication.

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

OVERVIEW

HOPE THEY LEARNED A LESSON!

Audiences love this humorous yet emotional play highlighting the difficulties associated with intolerance, disabilities, one-punch cowardly hits and bullying.

THE STORY

Dominic Lollo is a new boy at the school. He lost an arm in a car accident. Most of the pupils accept him except "Spider" Townley and his "gang" - boys and girls. Relationships simmer until Spider accidentally falls overboard from a stolen fishing boat.

Dominic, diving in from the shoreline, rescues Spider – the others can't swim.

The resulting Courtroom drama leaves the audience applauding.

INVOLVEMENT

Act 4 can involve parents as "Judges" (instead of the Applause Machine).

Act 6 requires a small "tinny" in front of stage with fishing gear and anchor etc. A local parent may get involved in setting up an imaginary river and boat scene. Spider falls in and Dominic rescues him – front of stage. Act 7, the Courtroom scene, could include a couple of "popular" teachers out of character, dancing the "Lollipop" song.

SONGS

"My Boy Lollipop"

"Show A Little Kindness"

"You'll Never Walk Alone"

"The Other Man's Grass"

TALENT QUEST

"Redback On The Toilet Seat"

"Yellow Submarine"

Many other songs and dances according to time-limits.

LENGTH

The Other Man's Grass is about 1 hour long. It may be lengthened or shortened in ACT 4, the Talent Quest. An interval could be included before ACT 4.

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

THE CHARACTERS

PAMELA	- one of the lead girls in the playground
SHEILAH	- broad Aussie accent
JOSIE	- opinionated
HILDA	- friendly
DOMINIC	- new boy with one arm
JUNIOR	- Dominic's friend
SPIDER	- playground bully
BMX	- one of Spider's gang
SPIKE	- follower of Spider
HOLLY	- friend of the gang
KARL	- gang member rides a skateboard
TEACHER	- comical character trips on things
MRS LOLLO	- Dominic's mother
MR LOLLO	- Dominic's father
SERGEANT	- Policeman
OFFICIAL	- Courtroom Bailiff
JUDGE	- loud with a heavy mallet

A large cast of non-speaking actors can participate in the playground scenes – skipping, eating sandwiches, depending on class grades performing the play.

Similarly, in the Talent Quest and in the Courtroom scene, extras can fill the stage filling non-distracting roles.



THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

THE PLAY

ACT 1: In the School playground. Lots of kids playing ball, hopscotch, hoops, handball etc. Curtains open as a number of kids are singing and dancing to the song "Lollipop" – choreography appropriate to age and school talent. Three girls, Pamela, Sheilah and Josie take the lead. (A school choir could be added to enhance the singing and involve other children.) The song ends as injured Dominic staggers onto the stage supported by friends. Dominic has been bullied by the gang. The scene ends when Dominic challenges Spider to a game of handball.

ACT 2: As the school bell rings, Spider and gang run in amongst the other kids to start playing handball. Scornfully he shouts that Dominic is too scared to come out of the classroom. But, Dominic has been kept in to finish his work. Pamela challenges Spider to show kindness. She begins a soliloquy introducing the song "Show A Little Kindness". Scene ends as (comical) Teacher gathers school equipment ending up with a bucket on his foot, dropping tennis balls etc. as Curtain closes.

ACT 3: At the Lollo's home. Mr and Mrs Lollo discuss why Dominic has a plaster on his nose and what Dominic should do about it.

ACT 4: The night of the "Talent Quest" (or school X-Factor – whatever is appropriate). Stage displays various signs, awards and a smaller platform for artists to perform on. Curtains open as Pamela and girls are finishing their version of "Lollipop". The Teacher becomes a focal point for this scene as he comically introduces the acts and controls the "applause machine".

ACT 5 Scene 1: Darkened stage. Spider and gang are waiting. They accost Dominic and rob him on his way home from school. Curtains close as he sings "The Other Man's Grass".

ACT 5 Scene 2: Teacher and others return to right the wrong.

ACT 6: Under Harper's Bridge. Scene opens on "gang" sitting around dividing up the money they stole from Dominic. They confirm that neither Dominic nor Junior will tell their parents because they would be too scared. Spider suggests they steal a fishing boat. Others arrive just as Spider falls out of boat. None of the "gang" can swim. Dominic dives in and rescues Spider. Police arrive.

ACT 7: Courtroom scene. Spider and "gang" get their punishments. Court room procedures gradually deteriorate until Teacher and Judge end up dancing and singing to "My Boy Lollipop" and "The Other Man's Grass" to finish.

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 1



SCHOOL PLAYGROUND. Curtains open on a number of children practicing, dancing and singing "My Boy Lollipop" for the coming School Talent Quest – or School X-Factor etc. Author suggests the School Choir could be added (off-stage) to the scene. Lots of other kids activities in the background like skipping, handball, eating lunches etc. The main characters singing are Pamela, Sheila and Josie. Dominic, Junior, Spider and his "gang" enter later in this Scene.

(As "My Boy Lollipop" concludes, Dominic staggers onto the stage supported by Junior and friends).

PAMELA: (Shouting) Ooh! Wah! What happened? (Dominic has bloody nose, black eye, bandage around head etc. - all gather around)

JUNIOR: (Complaining) Oh! It was Spider Townley again – and his gang.

DOMINIC: (Whimpering) We just wanted to play handball with them ...

JUNIOR: ... and they started punching into us ... especially Dominic ... they shouted, "Get lost freak!".

JOSIE: (Loudly) Why?

JUNIOR: (in disgust) Just because (holding Dominic's sleeve) Dominic has only got one arm. (wipes blood off Dominic's face).

PAMELA: More like, just because he's jealous!

JUNIOR: Jealous? Jealous of what?

JOSIE: Dominic can't help it if his father is rich!

SHEILAH: Yeh! I reckon that Spider ... and those kids think you're posh!

JUNIOR: Either that or it's because Dominic's ... well ... different! (indicating missing arm).

PAMELA: Yeh! Remember last week when we were playing softball ... they laughed when it was Dominic's turn to bat.

JOSIE: But, they didn't laugh when you pitched them all out, hey Dom., with your good arm!

DOMINIC: Well I think they hate me because my name is Lollo – Dominic Lollo!

JOSIE: Nah! Everybody hates their name, Lollipop ... I mean Dominic ...

PAMELA: (interrupting) And we only call you "Lollipop" for a nickname. Hey!

SHEILAH: We all know why YOU call him "Lollipop".

JOSIE: (and a few others shout) ... Yeh! 'cause you're sweet on him! (laughs - coy reaction by Pamela).

PAMELA: (gathering herself – raising her voice) Well, Dominic's father, Mr Lollo, has donated lots of things to this school! ... and he's donating the prize money for tomorrow night's Talent Quest ... isn't he!

(All nod and mumble, "Yes!" "Sure is!" etc. in agreement)

JUNIOR: ... you all right now Dom? (Dom nods, wipes face and puts handkerchief into pocket).

DOMINIC: (pausing) Well ... (as kids start playing again – walks closer to front of stage) Dad likes helping people. That's why he helps the school. He's donating the money to help the kids ... talented or not!

JUNIOR: (Scornfully) Spider hasn't got any talent!

DOMINIC: Spider reckons he is going to WIN the contest ... "Or else!" he said.

JOSIE: What can he do that's got talent??

PAMELA: Probably bash somebody up!

DOMINIC: Well, they're all gonna sing "Yellow Submarine" ... that's what they SAID!

PAMELA: We'll do "Lollipop" then ... and WIN. We've been practising enough.

JOSIE: Why don't you sing something DOM?

SHEILAH: Yeh! You're in the Choir.

DOMINIC: Oh! I don't think so ... especially if Spider's gang is going to be there.

SHEILAH: Look, if we let them scare us, they'll only keep on bullying and bashing kids up.

DOMINIC: (Walking to front-stage) What we've got to do is show them that we're all equal ... no matter (indicating missing arm) what we look like ... or (three girls bunch and pose) what we're good at ... we're all ... well ... we (gives Junior a high five) can still be friends, can't we! (All give high fives, hugs, lots of positive shouts).

(Enter Spider and gang – chewing gum, girls with make-up, boys with shirts out etc.)

PAMELA: (Urgent loud whisper) Here's Spider!

SPIDER: (Shouts) What's the matter Lollipop? Blackbird peck off your nose? (Gang all laugh, Spider high fives his friends)

SHEILAH: We're not scared of you Spider. (Louder) You're just a loud mouth know-all!



SPIDER: Yeh? (nose to nose)

SHEILAH: Yeh!

SPIDER: Yeh?

All DOMINIC'S friends: (loudly) YEHHH!

SPIDER: (starts to exit stage) Come of guys, let's go play some handball ... 'stead of hangin' around with this bunch of sissies!

JUNIOR: (shouts after them) Dominic can beat YOU at handball ... with ONE ARM anyway!

SPIDER: (turning back) YEH?

PAMELA: (running up to Spider) You're not game to challenge him on your own, are you!

SPIDER: (walking towards DOM - shouting) OK! You're challenged Lollipop! (Spider walks away)

BMX: (as they exit) Meet you on the handball court at lunchtime, sissies!

(Gang all rhubarb, rhubarb, "we'll show 'em" etc. – exit)

(Teacher with cape and mortar board enters scene, trips on ropes or balls, wanders around with big cane, slapping hand)

JUNIOR: (excitedly) This is going to be the game of the century!

DOMINIC: Well, I'm only playing him because he needs to be taught a lesson.

(Teacher rings a bell – begins to round up children and shoo! them out of playground scene)

SHEILAH: Pamela, I know the bell just rang but can we practice the ending of "Lollipop" again ... before we go into class?

PAMELA: Great idea ... and this one's for Lollipop ... at the handball courts ... Ready? 1, 2, 3, 4

(Choir and girls rehearse last chorus of "Lollipop")

CURTAINS

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 2



SCHOOL PLAYGROUND – Handball courts - Bell rings – curtains open as Spider and gang run onto stage and start to play handball. Others enter later.

BMX: You'll smash that creep Lollipop, Spider. No one in the school can beat YOU at handball.

HOLLEY: (grabs BMX by the arm) Careful BMX! He might only have one arm, but you saw him at the softball the other day ... (pushes his arm in a swinging motion) pitched you out!

SPIDER: Doesn't matter Holly. I'll beat him with some fancy stuff like this ... (bounces ball through legs to BMX)

SPIKE and BMX: (Pointing) Here they come!

(Enter Pamela, Sheilah, Josie and others – whatever the stage will permit – they start to play handball too).

SPIDER: (shouting – still playing handball – as others enter) Hey everyone, I've got a riddle for you ... what's got eyeballs that roll, lots of money to grab and one arm to tug on?

SPIKE: Sounds like an old Poker machine ...

SPIDER: No dummy ... Dominic Lollo, the "Lollipop" (gang all laugh – high fives etc.)

PAMELA: (running over to Spider – shouts) That's not funny Spider! (Stamps on his toe)

SPIDER: Aaahh! (bounces around holding his foot – ends up near Josie)

JOSIE: When are you going to show some kindness to people, Spider.

SPIDER: (nose to nose) Ah! Rats to you, creep!

PAMELA: (coming to her aid – pushes Spider) Dominic has done nothing to you ... and (pointing to his arm) he's got a handicap.

SPIDER: Where is that little toff anyway? (pushing back)

HILDA: He's still in class. Sir wouldn't let him come out 'till he's finished his work.

SHEILAH: (excitedly) Oh! Hilda, did you tell Sir about the handball game?

HILDA: No! No! ... Dominic and Junior just got kept in.

SPIDER: (sarcastically to his gang) He's chickened out guys.

HOLLY: (pointing to Hilda) Pretending to do his homework, hey!

(Commotion - gang all shout, "Yeh! Ha! Etc. chickened out!")

BMX: Lollipop has been licked ... get it? Lollipop has been licked!

SPIKE: Ha! Ha! A licked lollipop. That's funny. (All still laughing).

PAMELA: (points and shouts) You guys are so unkind!

HILDA: Why can't you show a little bit of kindness to Dominic ... you know ... don't be ...

SHEILAH: ... don't be so narrow minded ...

HILDA: He's only new to our school.

SPIDER: Yeh! Well he's a little toff, I reckon. (Introductory music starts for song "Try A Little Kindness")

PAMELA: You're always talking about him ... how would you like to have only one arm ... (starts to walk around singing ad lib to various gang members ... starting with Spider)

PAMELA: (Singing) "Don't talk about the down and out (pushes Spider) ... lend a helping hand ... (raises Spike's arm) instead of doubt ... (to Holly) And the kindness that you show in every way ... (to BMX and Spider) will help someone along their way". (They wave Hilda away with disgust) (Choir joins in if available) (All on stage sing Chorus of song after each verse).

PAMELA: "You've ... got ... to ... (a tempo) try a little kindness ..."

(During song, gang perform "bad deeds" like graffiti on walls, "Spider was here!", tip over rubbish bins etc. – others perform "good deeds" like picking up rubbish, elderly lady drops her purse, another returns it etc. – kids dress up for the occasions)

(Song ends)

PAMELA: (walking up to Spider – gives him a ball) Seeing Dominic isn't here yet, you can play ME! I challenge YOU!

(Spider holds up ball and gang all laugh and high five etc. – others shout Hooray! Yeh! Get him excitedly)

SPIDER: (scornfully) YOU challenge ME! ... Ha! ... come on everyone ... you gotta see this!
(All gather around, semi-circle – facing audience)
(Spider quickly serves to Pamela, she misses, all gang laugh and react).

PAMELA: (catching ball thrown to her) I wasn't ready! ... (Others shout, "You're a cheat!" "Not yet!" etc.) ... try this one Spider! ... (the game continues for a few seconds as Dominic and Junior enter)

JOSIE: (Shouts) Hey! Here they are. Here's Dominic. (all react)

SPIDER: (taking another ball from his pocket) Hey, Lollipop, ready to get LICKED? (all react)

DOMINIC: (eating his lunch, bandaid on nose – walks away from Spider) Sorry, we're late everyone. Got kept in. (School bell rings).

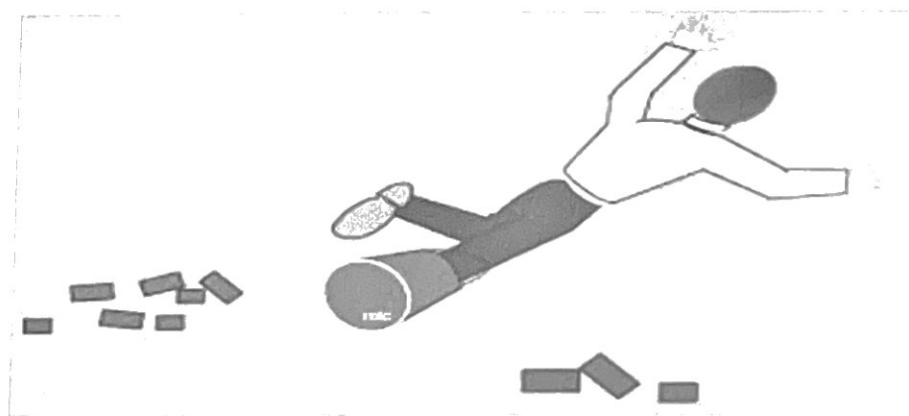
SPIDER: (Walking up to face Dominic) Saved by the bell, Huh! Lollipop. (They stand face to face).

JOSIE: (points excitedly) Here comes Sir. (Teacher enters scene).

TEACHER: (With cane in hand) What's going on here? (trips over – all laugh) Didn't you lot hear the Bell? (trips over again).

(All start exiting the stage with commotion, loud talking, throwing balls, gloves etc.)

TEACHER: (collecting play equipment) There'll be no Talent Quest for you lot tonight. (Keeps picking up things and dropping them – trips over again, steps in a bucket as he gets up) (To audience) This would be a great job if there were no kids at the school. (Exits with bucket on his foot – mumbling, "Rotten kids!" etc.



THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 3

AT THE LOLLO'S HOME

Scene opens with Mrs Lollo in the kitchen preparing dinner. She wears an apron. Mr Lollo is helping, watching TV, reading



MRS LOLLO: Dinner's ready! (to off stage) Dominic, come and get it!
(Mr Lollo stops what he is doing and sits at the head of the table, smells the dinner on the plate)

MR LOLLO: Mmmm! Smells delicious, dear!
(Enter Dominic holding a (pet) or toy. Dominic has a band-aid across nose)

MRS LOLLO: Here let me take (pet) Dominic. (She puts (pet) on a chair next to Dominic)

MR LOLLO: (Whilst eating) What happened to your nose son? (Dominic looks at mother)

MRS LOLLO: Oh! The teacher put a plaster across a small cut dear ... he came home from school like that.

MR LOLLO: Yes, but what happened?

DOMINIC: Well, it's like this Dad ...

MRS LOLLO: (interrupting) ... Oh! Come now ... eat your dinner ...

MR LOLLO: (sternly) Mother, would you stop changing the subject! Have you been fighting son?

DOMINIC: Well ... Dad ... Spider Townley and his gang ...

MR LOLLO: (cutting in) I knew it! (stands up) You got into a fight!

DOMINIC: No Dad! He just punched me for nothing.

MR LOLLO: (angrily) Nothing! People don't punch each other for nothing!

MRS LOLLO: (serving meal to Dominic) Well this boy Townley doesn't like Dominic.

MR LOLLO: Why? (starts walking around)

DOMINIC: Oh! I don't know why ... something about my nickname. (starts eating)

MR LOLLO: (as he sits back down) Nickname? (picks up a fork full of food)

DOMINIC: Yeh! The kids call me "Lollipop"

MR LOLLO: (pausing with mouth open – fork near mouth) You've heard of "sticks and stones" haven't you son?

DOMINIC: Oh! The nickname doesn't worry me Dad...

MRS LOLLO: ... and one boy held him while the other boy cowardly punched him in the nose!

DOMINIC: I think some of those kids are just jealous ... because you gave some money to the school and their parents can't afford to donate ... Spider, especially, he's really mad!

MR LOLLO: Would he be the son of that drunk Tom Townley who spends all his money on poker machines and grog?

DOMINIC: Yeh! That's him.

MRS LOLLO: That explains why that young gang are always after money ... taking and breaking into other people's property.

DOMINIC: What do you mean mum?

MR LOLLO: His Dad doesn't make him feel wanted, loved ... so he's really looking for something better... he'll just explode at any time ...

MRS LOLLO: You know what some people say, "The other man's grass is ..."

DOMINIC: "The other man's grass?"

MRS LOLLO: (picks up (pet), strokes it if appropriate) Yes, some people are never content with what they've got ... always wanting some "greener grass" from over the fence ... always whinging ...

MR LOLLO: ... and they join gangs for support.

DOMINIC: Yeh! That's Spider all right. But what good is a gang of friends if you're always fighting and complaining?

MR LOLLO: Exactly son. So let's see if we can convince this young Townley that there is someone who cares about him. (Mrs Lollo puts (pet) back onto chair, sits and begins her meal.

DOMINIC: How?

MR LOLLO: Well the best way is by example ... don't just wait around, go out and show him we care.

DOMINIC: (pick up piece of pie to eat) With him it might take a long time Dad.

MR LOLLO: You never know son. He might need your help tomorrow.

DOMINIC: Boy this pie is beaut mum!

MR LOLLO: That's it son! See ... you didn't have to be asked if you were enjoying your meal ... you complimented your mother! That's what we have to do to "Cockroach"!

DOMINIC: "Spider" Dad.

MR LOLLO: ... That's what we have to do to Spider ... show him love

MRS LOLLO: (Puts out dessert and pours cup of tea) Love thy neighbour!

DOMINIC: OK! Dad. I'll try.

MRS LOLLO: You can do that with your friends and other neighbours too. (Dominic nods)

MR LOLLO: Pass the tomato sauce please dear.

MRS LOLLO: Oh! You and your tomato sauce ... (curtains begin to close) ... you want it on everything, (smiles all round).

MR LOLLO: Now dear, I just want some over here in this space near my pie.

CURTAINS

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 4



"Talent Quest" signs and decorations about the walls - small centre stage, raised up for acts. Director may choose to use "School's Got Talent" or "Our X-Factor" etc. Curtains open on girls Pamela, Sheila and Josie) performing last chorus of "My Boy Lollipop". All characters from cast and other students fill the stage. Choir may be involved to add parents to the audience! All applaud as Teacher trips up onto raised stage – lots of laughter from cast. An "Applause Machine" with a large clock dial, secretly operated from the inside by a small student sits at the side of the stage.

TEACHER: (calming everyone down) Thankyou girls, thank you. (the girls go and take their seats) That was a fine rendition of the old song. (Pointing at "Applause Machine" to side of stage). The applause machine reached (shouts) 8.5, a very good effort. One more round of applause for our first act. (All shout and applaud).

Next on our Talent Quest is _____ performing _____

Teacher continues to introduce and commend a few more acts as time permits. Some of the acts reach 7.5 on the "Applause Machine" – teacher gives recognition to each act.

Now for our next act, Spider Townley and the Cobwebs. (Waves his arm to indicate - a few of the gang move up to the centre stage – others push their way through complaining students).

(Spider and gang sing "Redback on The Toilet Seat" or "Yellow Submarine" or some contemporary song - with all joining in chorus. Loud applause breaks out as gang goes to front of stage and encourages audience to shout and clap, or else! - the "Applause Machine" reaches 9.0 – the dial goes crazy!)

SPIDER AND GANG: (Sneering at Dominic and girls) Hah! Beat that you creeps! (Waves to audience, high-fives with gang members.)

TEACHER: Wow! That's a big number, 9.0 Wow! That is going to be hard to beat. (Looking at watch) We're running out of time so that will have to be the last act for tonight.

SHEILAH: (Standing up) What about Dominic?

PAMELA: (Standing up) Yeh! We want Dominic!

OTHERS: (Joining in the protest) We want Dominic! We want Dominic! We want Dominic!

TEACHER: (With a calming gesture) All right! All Right! (looking around) Where are you Lollipop? I mean Dominic! (Friends help him up and usher him up onto stage – other cheer!)

(Dominic stands on the stage and adjusts his coat, showing audience (not deliberately) he has just one arm. Waits until there is silence)

DOMINIC: "When you walk, through a storm ... etc." (Or sing some other appropriate song like "Rainbow Connection" or whatever copyright can be accessed)

Song ends – applause breaks out – cast (except gang) go crazy, encouraging audience to clap and shout. "Applause Machine" goes past 10 and emits smoke/steam.

TEACHER: (shouting to audience – jumping up onto stage) He did it! He did it! Stay up here Dominic. I didn't think anyone would beat 9. (Louder) Let's hear it for the winner of the Talent Quest! (Applause and cheering) And here to present the prize to the winner is Mr Lollo. (Mr Lollo comes forward from behind stage with trophy and envelope).

MR LOLLO: (Teacher welcomes him with handshake) Thank you sir! (looks around indicating) and all of you boys and girls. It's rather a surprise having to present the prize to Dominic, my son. But you know (pointing) the "Applause Machine" doesn't lie! And you are the judges.

SPIDER: (and gang all stand and wave their arms – shouting) Ah! Rats!

GANG: (rhubarb, rhubarb etc. shouting) You're all cheats! It's rigged! (all stomp off shouting) We'll get you! You'll be sorry! Etc.

MR LOLLO: (as all goes quiet when gang leaves) Well of course, we can't ALL be first. (Kids help Dominic to stage again) Now, son, congratulations. (presents trophy and envelope) You chose a fine song and you sang it great! Your mother and I are very proud of you. (turns to Teacher) I have to go to a very important meeting now, so (to Dominic) walk home with your friends and keep your prize money in a safe place.

DOMINIC: (putting envelope into jacket) Thanks dad. I will.

TEACHER: (as Mr Lollo and Dominic leave) Let's hear it one more time for Dominic Lollo, and all of the other contestants! (applause and cheering) The winner of the Talent Quest for 20— (pointing to the sound desk) OK, DJ guy, let's pump up some music. How about a square dance? (He trips off the stage as curtains close and music starts – others help him up and start dancing with him)

CURTAINS

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 5 Scene 1



STREET SCENE with bins, cans and papers blowing through. Darkened stage – gang standing around waiting to accost Dominic and steal his prize money.

HOLLY: How do you know he's coming this way?

SPIDER: (Tossing a coin and catching it) You heard – Mr Lollo's gone to a meeting ... Lollipop has to walk home ... he HAS to come this way.

BMX: (playing a game on his phone) What are you going to say to him Spider?

SPIDER: (Walking over to BMX) Not "what are you gonna SAY to him?" it's what are you gonna DO to him? (slam his fist into his hand near BMX's face)

SPIKE: Heh! (Thumbs up) Yeh!

BMX: Well whatever happens, we meet later under the bridge, right!

SPIKE: **HOLLY:** **SPIDER:** (Noisily) Heh! Yeh! OK! Right, under Harper's Bridge.

KARL: (playing on his skateboard) (Shouts) They'll never find us there.

SPIDER: They might find us but they'll never find the loot we snatch from Lollipop!
(Dominic and Junior enter from the side)

SPIKE: (Pointing – shouting sarcastically) Hehhh! It's Lollipop time!
(Spider and gang surround them – they try to make a run for it)

SPIDER: (grabbing Dominic in a headlock – facing audience) Where are you going Lollipop?

JUNIOR: Leave us alone Spider! (Gang grabs Junior – Junior breaks free and runs off stage with others chasing him)

BMX: Get him! (Others run, knocking over bins and kicking tins etc.)

SPIDER: (Shouts to others) Don't worry about him!

HOLLY: But, Spider, he'll go for help! (Other gang members return to stage empty handed)

KARL: GANG: He got away. We couldn't find him. It's too dark! Etc.

SPIDER: He'll just whimper home to mummy. (Dominic struggles) ... here's the one we want!
(Spider let's him free – other members push him from one to the other)

BMX: Win a prize, eh! Lollipop.

SPIKE: Where's the prize money Lollipop? (Reaching into his trouser pockets)

SPIDER: (taking control – reaches inside Dominic's jacket pockets – pulls out an envelope).
Here it is! This is the money that really belongs to us!

DOMINIC: You'll never get away with it Spider (reaching for the envelope)

SPIDER: Hah! (pushing Dominic) Just watch me! (Punches Dominic extra hard – Dominic falls down – hits his head, screams and holds his forehead then lays back unconscious – gang gathers around, looking anxious)

HOLLY: Ooh! Wah! You've killed him Spider ... you king hit him!

KARL: Now we're in for it!

SPIDER: (looking a bit worried) Nah! He's OK! ... but ... let's get out of here.

(All exit, leaving Dominic laying on the floor. Few seconds go by before he begins to rouse.

He gradually stands up, as music starts introducing a slow segue into song "The Other Man's Grass" . Dominic moves to front of curtains to sing the song. Choir may be used to supplement).

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 5 Scene 2

CURTAINS open as song ends. JUNIOR runs onto stage (same scene) with Teacher and crowd of other pupils.

JUNIOR: There he is. You all right Dominic? (All gather around)

TEACHER: Which way did they go?

DOMINIC: Towards the river, Sir! (All mumble about river and Harper's Bridge)

TEACHER: (In his stern Teacher's voice) Right everyone! We'll spread out and look for them. Sheilah and Josie, you go to the Police Station, it's just down the street. Get Sergeant Hancock and tell him where to go!

TOGETHER: Yes, Sir! (Looking enquiringly at each other)

TEACHER: Pamela. You and the girls go over to Fisherman's Wharf ... but if they are there, don't let you see them! ... just come back here and report to us! (Pamela and girls look at each other, raise hands and shrug shoulders, then run off stage on tip toes)

TOGETHER: Yes, Sir!

JUNIOR: Dom and I can go down to Harper's Bridge, Sir! To see if they are there.

DOMINIC: Yeh! I'm OK now Sir! I've seen them hanging around under the bridge a lot.

TEACHER: OK! Boys, but remember ... just report back here if you find them.

JUNIOR: Right Sir! (They run off stage with others following. Teacher is left by himself).

TEACHER: Now that leaves just ... (he looks around for others) ... Just ME! (Puts his back to the wall looking side to side, scared – then to audience, he points down the street). I know, I'll drop into the Pub. (To audience) Well they might be hiding in the Bar! (Smiles and exits)

CURTAINS

THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 6



UNDER HARPER'S BRIDGE

Backdrop – under a bridge end. Small boats tied up to a small pier. Graffiti here and there.

Scene opens on gang sitting around the river bank (edge of stage) and others counting money on a stack of empty old boxes.

SPIDER: (Counting out notes onto boxes) 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20. There, that's the lot. Now we'll hang around under the bridge until the heat's off. (Gang put money together and hide securely in pockets etc. Spider puts his in the envelope and, so that audience can see, places the envelope in his top pocket).

HOLLY: But what about Junior? He might have run for help when he got away from us.

SPIDER: He know that if he dobs us in, we get him too, right?

BMX: Yeh! That little creep.

KARL: Well, we can't stay here too long ... I mean ... none of us can even swim!!

SPIKE: Yeh! Man! Crazee ... (stepping down near a boat and kicking the water) Water is too wet for me!

SPIDER: Look, it's just for one night, get it! Junior wasn't even there when we took our Prize Money back. We'll say we went fishing straight after the Talent Quest. If we ALL have the same story, Lollipop and Junior can't prove a thing.

BMX: Hey, why don't we actually GO fishing? (pointing at boat) There's fishing gear in here, look. (They jump into small boat moored in front of stage).

KARL: Yeh! (Picking up oars) Let's get going before somebody turns up.

SPIDER: OK! Let's go! (Jumps into boat)

HOLLY: (about to hop into boat - noises off stage – loud whisper) Hey! Someone's coming.

SPIKE: Hurry up Karl ... let me in (Karl and Spike jostle each other) Don't push, I can't swim!

SPIDER: (to BMX) Untie the rope dummy. (Confused, BMX picks up the rope in the boat)

BMX: (Pushes Spider) Don't call me dummy!

SPIDER: (Pushes BMX) Yeh! Who's the leader around here?

HOLLY: Stop arguing you two, there's someone coming.

BMX: Don't push ME Spider! (Pushes Spider who trips backwards and falls backwards towards audience into the "water", out of sight of audience)

HOLLY: (Screams) Eeeek! You've pushed him in you idiot!

KARL: (Shouts) He can't SWIM. (Spider shouts "Help!")

SPIKE: Throw him something! (Karl picks up a large anchor – Holly screams again)

BMX: NOT THAT! You'll kill him.

HOLLY: What'll we do? I can't swim either. (Spider shouts again)

KARL: (to Holly) Oh! Stop panicking Holly!

SPIKE: I'll reach out (reaches out over side of boat ... nearly falls in ... Holly rushes, jumps out of boat, grabs a stick and unsuccessfully reaches out to Spider)

HOLLY: I can't reach him.

BMX: He's going under. (Enter Dominic and Junior)

DOMINIC: (shouting) They are here! (Looks back as everyone enters) OK, where's Spider, you lot? Sergeant Hancock is on his way, so don't try anything smart.

HOLLY: (shouting and screaming) Spider's out there in the water ... he's drowning ... we can't find him.

JUNIOR: Neither can I.

DOMINIC: I can ... I'll save him! (Removes shoes -jumps in fully clothed)

BMX: (All point and look at where Spider is “floundering”) How can he swim with just one arm?

JUNIOR: He’s there. Spider’s holding onto him.

(Pamela and others rush onto the stage)

JOSIE: (Pointing out to the rescue) Look, it’s Dominic. Someone’s holding onto him.

PAMELA: Spider? Is that Spider holding Dominic?

KARL: Yeh! Dominic’s a hero. (Shouts) Swim this way Lollipop. (Other’s make hand movements to call them in).

SPIKE: Boy! I didn’t think they’d make it!

PAMELA: You guys underestimate everybody.

HOLLY: Help him up! (They drag Spider and Dominic from the water – over the edge of the Stage – Spider just lays there).

DOMINIC: (Standing over Spider) I’ll give him mouth to mouth ... you hold him under the neck
BMX. (Sergeant Hancock and others arrive)

BMX: Sure, Dom.

SERGEANT: Well now, what have we here? (Dominic keeps on with the mouth to mouth)

HOLLY: (Kneeling down near Dominic) This is our friend Spider. (Touches his hair)

KARL: And this is our other friend, Lollipop ... I mean Dominic.

JUNIOR: PAMELA: JANE: SUSAN: (Loudly) Other friend!

BMX: And Dominic just saved Spider’s life. (Spider begins to cough and revive)

CROWD: (All begin to clap and congratulate Dominic and each other)

SHEILAH: (Sergeant waves his arms to quietens the noisy crowd) Quiet everyone! (To Sergeant Hancock) Sergeant, these are the ones who stole the Prize money. (Pointing to Spider and gang who have gathered around him, assisting him to stand)

SERGEANT: Is that so, indeed. (Rubs fingers together in a gesture to gang to return the money)

SPIKE: (Reaching hand into pocket and holding out notes) OK! OK! Here's mine. (Gives money to Sergeant)

PAMELA: (Hands on hips) OK! Where's the rest? (Looking sternly at gang members)

DOMINIC: I know! Here's some in Spider's pocket (pulls out envelope) It's still in Dad's envelope. (As Pamela and others stand nose to nose with gang members, they slowly give back the money in their pockets)

SERGEANT: Well ... that's enough evidence for me. (To gang members) You lot will come with me, now. (To Dominic and Pamela and pointing at Spider) Help him along now ... I'll see the rest of you in the Court House tomorrow. (They carry Spider off following the Sergeant).

JOSIE: Woe! We're ALL going to Court tomorrow.

SHEILAH: (Excitedly) To be witnesses.

HILDA: Now Spider and his bunch will really get what's coming to them.

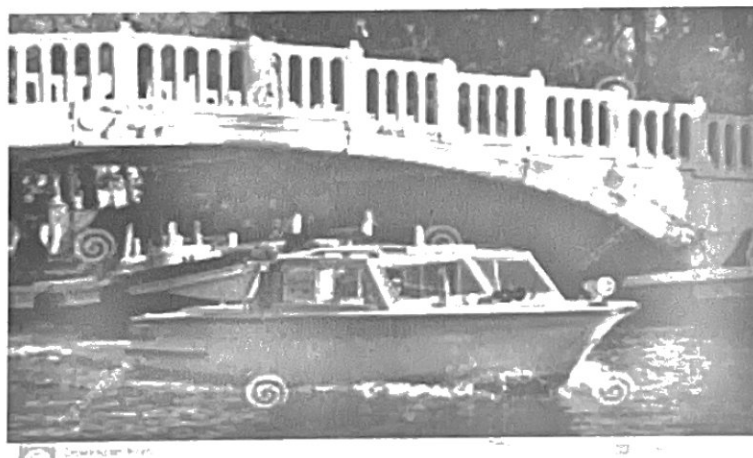
PAMELA: Maybe now they'll leave Dominic alone. (All begin to exit)

SUSAN: They might get the electric chair! (All laugh)

JUNIOR: Or 20 years in solitary or something!

PAMELA: We'll see tomorrow. It's exciting isn't it! (Curtains begin to close) Hey girls, what'll we wear to the Court House?

CURTAINS



THE OTHER MAN'S GRASS

ACT 7



COURT ROOM Scene opens on a crowded courtroom – Jury and noisy public gallery. Spider and gang are in the dock guarded by Police. Teacher is talking to Pamela and girls. Court Official taps on table to get everyone's attention as Judge enters. Court Recorder is sitting at table.

OFFICIAL: (Shouting) Hear Ye! Hear Ye! All stand for the Right Honourable Judge Loftus Beak. (Judge walks to his chair, looks around, sits. All sit.)

OFFICIAL: (Loudly) This Court is now in session.

JUDGE: Sergeant Hancock, what have we got today?

SERGEANT: Your Honour ... (pointing at dock) ... this gang, led by our friend Spider Townley, is charged with malicious bodily injury to one Dominic Lollo. Plus, theft of a cash amount of two hundred dollars, prize money from the School Talent Quest.

JUDGE: School Talent Quest, Huh!

SERGEANT: Yes, your honour. A number of witnesses will be called ... (indicating) ... all present here today.

JUDGE: Call your first witness, Sergeant!

SERGEANT: I call Pamela ... would you step forward please. (Pamela comes out to front) Could you tell the Court in your own words, exactly what happened at school on Monday last.

PAMELA: Well, (indicating) we were practicing our song in the playground and Dominic turned up with a bleeding nose ... he had been bashed by Spider Townley and his gang.

JUNIOR: (Jumping to his feet) Yeh! And I saw it, I was there with Dominic. (Shouting)

CROWD: (Together - noisily) So was I. It was Spider all right! He just wanted to play handball! The gang held him. Spider punched him. He King hit him! Then we saw he was bleeding. He's only got one arm.

JUDGE: (Standing, banging his gavel) Silence! Silence! Silence in Court! (Teacher waves his arms at pupils, points finger; Policeman moves around – noise drops) One at a time ... continue young lady!

PAMELA: And ... after the Talent Quest, they bashed Dominic again and stole his money!

SHEILAH: Junior can tell you all about that.

JOSIE: Go on Junior.

JUDGE: Silence! in court. Thank you young lady, you may step down. Who's next?

TEACHER: Junior Jones is our next witness Your Honour. (Policeman brings him forward) Well done Pamela.

HOLLY: (To the gang – in a loud crying tone) I told you we should have stopped him ... I told you!

SPIDER: (Echoing Holly with sarcasm) "I told you so", "I told you so" ... would you dry up Holly! (Spider tries to step forward – stopped by Policeman) Your Honour, can I say something before the next witness?

JUDGE: (Looking at Sergeant Hancock) What do you think Sergeant?

SERGEANT: Well, he does seem to be a reformed person since Dominic saved his life.

SPIDER: That's what I want to talk about, Your Honour.

JUDGE: Oh! All right. (Pointing to Junior) You can return the witness Sergeant. (Teacher leads Junior back to his seat)

TEACHER: Yes, Your Honour.

JUDGE: Take the stand young Townley. (Spider is led to the witness stand)

SPIDER: (Puts his hand on the Bible and repeats the oath – then in a loud voice) Your Honour, we would like to plead GUILTY to the charges. (Courtroom noisily erupts with Ooh! and Aah! etc.) (Judge repeatedly bangs gavel)

JUDGE: Silence! Silence! Silence in my Courtroom.

SPIDER: Your Honour, BMX, Spike, Karl, Holly and all of us ... we've had Dominic pegged all wrong.

BMX: Yeh! He may be a toff, but he's also a HERO. (Loud cheers from courtroom – Judge bangs gavel again several times – all quieten down)

SPIDER: He didn't HAVE TO save me ... (wipes away a tear) ... but he did.

HOLLY: So we're all going to apologise ... (sternly to gang) aren't we! Ready?

GANG: (Together) Sorry, Lollipop.

JUDGE: Sorry, LOLLIPOP!

JUDGE: Lollipop? Who's Lollipop?

PAMELA: Dominic, Your Honour. We call him Lollipop.

ALL: Yeh! 'Cause you're sweet on him!

JOSIE: And we sing a song about him!

JUDGE: Oh! I do love the good old songs! Which one?

DOMINIC: Well, you'll love this one Your Honour ... it's real old!

PAMELA: Would you like to hear how it goes? (dragging the others onto the Courtroom floor)

JUDGE: This is most unusual, young lady ... I don't know if ... (Girls start dancing)

JOSIE: 1, 2, 3, 4 ...

PAMELA: "Lollipop, Lollipop ... etc." (Judge stands ... bangs his gavel ... keeps it in his hand as he moves toward them. Teacher waves arms and tries to stop the music ... all get audience to clap along, sing etc. Sergeant is dragged along by Jane to join in the dancing ... Pamela shows Policeman how to dance ... Suzie gets Teacher to "groove" about. Choirs is singing by now.)

(Dominic and others hold up big signs saying, "END OF PLAY, BEGINNING OF FRIENDSHIP" and any appropriate sign for school. Choir and all cast modulate from "My Boy Lollipop" to Chorus of "The Other Man's Grass" to end the Play).

CURTAINS
END OF PLAY